Toric varieties

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Lecture 1

In this course, we do everything over $\mathbb{C}$. In particular, $\times$ means fibre product over $\mathrm{Spec}(\mathbb{C})$.

1 What is a toric variety?

Definition 1.1 (affine variety)
An *affine variety* is $V = \mathrm{Spec}(R)$, where R is a finitely generated integral[a] $\mathbb{C}$-algebra.

[a] R is an integral domain.

Fact: Given such an R, we can choose generators and relations, and write

$$R = \frac{\mathbb{C}[x_1, \ldots, x_n]}{I}$$

where I is a prime ideal. This gives an affine embedding. i.e. a closed embedding

$$V = \mathbb{V}(I) = \mathbb{A}^n$$

Note that the affine embedding is not unique.

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Definition 1.2 ((complex) variety)
A *(complex) variety* is a scheme X which is integral (reduced and irreducible), separated, and of finite type.

We can avoid schemes, and glue varieties out of affine varieties. We need

1. a finite collection $\{V_\alpha\}_{\alpha\in A}$ of affine varieties, say $V_\alpha = \mathrm{Spec}(R_\alpha)$,
2. for $\alpha, \beta \in A$, we need Zariski opens $V_{\alpha\beta} \subseteq V_\alpha$,
3. algebraic transition maps $g_{\alpha\beta} : V_{\alpha\beta} \to V_{\beta\alpha}$, satisfying the usual cocycle conditions,
4. check that the resulting
$$X = \frac{\bigsqcup_\alpha V_\alpha}{\sim}$$
is irreducible and separated (Hausdorff).

Definition 1.3 (torus)
An *(algebraic complex) torus of dimension n* is
$$\mathrm{T}^n = (\mathbb{C}^*)^n = \mathrm{Spec}(\mathbb{C}[x_1^{\pm 1}, \dots, x_n^{\pm 1}]) = (\mathbb{A}^1 \setminus \{0\})^n$$

Note that this is not the same as the usual torus $(S^1)^n$. In particular, we have an affine embedding
$$\mathrm{T}^n = \mathrm{Spec}\left(\frac{\mathbb{C}[z_0, \dots, z_n]}{\langle z_0 \cdots z_n - 1\rangle}\right) = \mathbb{V}(z_0 \cdots z_n - 1) \subseteq \mathbb{A}^{n+1}$$

Exercise: Check that we have an isomorphism of rings
$$\mathbb{C}[z_1^{\pm 1}, \dots, z_n^{\pm 1}] \cong \frac{\mathbb{C}[z_0, \dots, z_n]}{\langle z_0 \cdots z_n - 1\rangle}$$

The torus is also a *commutative group scheme*, that is, we have algebraic morphisms
$$\begin{aligned} e &: \bullet \to \mathrm{T}^n \\ m &: \mathrm{T}^n \times \mathrm{T}^n \to \mathrm{T}^n \\ i &: \mathrm{T}^n \to \mathrm{T}^n \end{aligned}$$
making T^n into an abelian group with identity e, multiplication m and inverse i. On the level of coordinate rings, we have the *identity section*,
$$\begin{aligned} e^\sharp : \mathbb{C}[t_1^{\pm 1}, \dots, t_n^{\pm 1}] &\to \mathbb{C} \\ t_i^{\pm 1} &\mapsto 1 \end{aligned}$$
The multiplication map is given by pointwise operations, i.e.
$$m((x_1, \dots, x_n), (y_1, \dots, y_n)) = (x_1 y_1, \dots, x_n y_n)$$
With this, we have *comultiplication*
$$\begin{aligned} m^\sharp : \mathbb{C}[t_1^{\pm 1}, \dots, t_n^{\pm 1}] &\to \mathbb{C}[x_1^{\pm 1}, \dots, x_n^{\pm 1}] \otimes \mathbb{C}[y_1^{\pm 1}, \dots, y_n^{\pm 1}] \\ t_i &\mapsto x_i \otimes y_i \end{aligned}$$
and the inverse map is given by
$$\begin{aligned} i^\sharp : \mathbb{C}[t_1^{\pm 1}, \dots, t_n^{\pm 1}] &\to \mathbb{C}[t_1^{\pm 1}, \dots, t_n^{\pm 1}] \\ t_i &\mapsto t_i^{-1} \end{aligned}$$

Definition 1.4 (toric variety)
A *toric variety* is a variety X with a dense open $\mathrm{T}^n \subseteq X$, and an action (i.e. algebraic map)

$$a : \mathrm{T}^n \times X \to X$$

which extends the multiplication on X.

Example 1.5
T^n is itself a toric variety.

Cohomology

Example 1.6
$\mathbb{A}^n = \mathrm{Spec}(\mathbb{C}[x_1, \ldots, x_n])$, with the torus

$$\mathrm{Spec}(\mathbb{C}[x_1^{\pm 1}, \ldots, x_n^{\pm 1}])$$

with

$$a((t_1, \ldots, t_n), (x_1, \ldots, x_n)) = (t_1 x_1, \ldots, t_n x_n)$$

Example 1.7
Projective space

$$\mathbb{P}^n = \mathrm{Proj}(\mathbb{C}[z_0, \ldots, z_n]) = \{(z_0 : \cdots : z_n) \mid (z_0, \ldots, z_n) \neq (0, \ldots, 0)\}$$

is also a toric variety, with torus

$$\mathrm{T}^n = \{(z_0 : \cdots : z_n) \mid z_0 \cdots z_n \neq 0\}$$

with action given coordinate-wise again, i.e.

$$a((t_0 : \cdots : t_n), (z_0 : \cdots : z_n)) = (t_0 z_0 : \cdots : t_n z_n)$$

in non-homogeneous coordinates (i.e. in the affine $z_0 \neq 0$) of the torus, we can define the action by

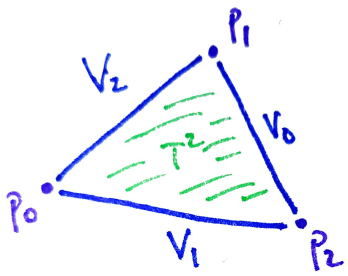
$$(t_1, \ldots, t_n) \cdot (z_0 : \cdots : z_n) = (z_0 : t_1 z_1 : \cdots : t_n z_n)$$

We can check that T^n is contained in all of the standard opens $U_i = D(z_i)$, and if we choose the usual affine coordinates, then T^n embeds into affine space as above.

Toric varieties are determined by the dimension n of the torus, and the *toric boundary* $X \setminus \mathrm{T}^n$. For example, $\mathbb{P}^2 \setminus \mathrm{T}^2$ has three components,

1. $V_0 = \mathbb{V}(z_0)$,
2. $V_1 = \mathbb{V}(z_1)$,
3. $V_2 = \mathbb{V}(z_2)$

The V_i intersect pairwise, but not all three at the same time. Each V_i is invariant under the action of the torus, so $\mathbb{P}^2$ can be represented as



In particular, this gives us a stratification of $\mathbb{P}^2$, with strata T^2, $\mathbb{C}^* = T^1$ corresponding to V_i with the vertices removed, and the three vertices.

2 Characters, cocharacters and lattices

Recall from the last lecture that $\mathrm{T}^n = (\mathbb{C}^*)^n$ is an algebraic group.

Definition 2.1 (character)
A *character* χ of T^n is a morphism $\chi : \mathrm{T}^n \to \mathbb{C}^*$ of algebraic groups. That is, $\chi : \mathrm{T}^n \to \mathbb{C}^*$ is a morphisms of schemes, such that

$$\chi(e) = 1 \quad \text{and} \quad (\chi^\sharp \otimes \chi^\sharp) \circ m^\sharp = m^\sharp \circ \chi^\sharp$$

We will write $\mathrm{Hom}_{\text{alg-gp}}(\cdot, \cdot)$ for the set of morphisms of algebraic groups.

Theorem 2.2. The characters of T^n are

$$M = \mathrm{Hom}_{\text{alg-gp}}(\mathrm{T}^n, \mathbb{C}^*) = \mathbb{Z}^n$$

Proof. First of all, note that

$$\mathrm{Hom}_{\text{alg-gp}}(\mathrm{T}^n, \mathbb{C}^*) = (\mathrm{Hom}(\mathbb{C}^*, \mathbb{C}^*))^n$$

Thus, without loss of generality $n = 1$. Now we need a $\mathbb{C}$-algebra map

$$\chi^\sharp : \mathbb{C}[x^{\pm 1}] \to \mathbb{C}[y^{\pm 1}]$$

This is determined by $\chi^\sharp(x) = p(y, y^{-1})$. Note that x is a unit in $\mathbb{C}[x^{\pm 1}]$, and so $\chi^\sharp(x)$ is a unit. Thus, $p(y, y^{-1}) = ay^k$, for some $a \in \mathbb{C}, k \in \mathbb{Z}$.

Next, we need that $e^\sharp \circ \chi^\sharp = \chi^\sharp \circ e^\sharp$. That is,

$$a = e^\sharp(\chi^\sharp(x)) = \chi^\sharp(e^\sharp(x)) = \chi^\sharp(1) = 1$$

Hence $\chi^\sharp(x) = x^k$, for some $k \in \mathbb{Z}$. Note that $\chi^\sharp(x \otimes x) = \chi^\sharp(x) \otimes \chi^\sharp(x)$ automatically, so we are done. □

The characters of T^n are of the form

$$\chi(t_1, \ldots, t_n) = t_1^{a_1} \cdots t_n^{a_n}$$

for some $(a_1, \ldots, a_n) \in \mathbb{Z}^n$. Expressions of the form

$$t_1^{a_1} \cdots t_n^{a_n}$$

are called *Laurent monomials*. We will write

$$\chi^{\mathbf{a}}(\mathbf{t}) = \mathbf{t}^{\mathbf{a}} = t_1^{a_1} \cdots t_n^{a_n}$$

for this character. The correspondence is then

$$\begin{aligned} \mathrm{Hom}_{\text{alg-gp}}(\mathsf{T}^n, \mathbb{C}^*) &\to \mathbb{Z}^n \\ \chi^{\mathbf{a}} &\mapsto \mathbf{a} \end{aligned}$$

The characters form a group. Given characters $\chi, \chi' : \mathsf{T}^n \to \mathbb{C}^*$,

$$\chi \cdot \chi'(\mathbf{t}) = \chi(\mathbf{t}) \cdot \chi'(\mathbf{t})$$

Thus, we have taht

$$\chi^{\mathbf{a}} \cdot \chi^{\mathbf{a}'} = \chi^{\mathbf{a}+\mathbf{a}'}$$

Hence the identification $\mathrm{Hom}_{\text{alg-gp}}(\mathsf{T}^n, \mathbb{C}^*) \cong \mathbb{Z}^n$ is also a group isomorphism.

Definition 2.3 (cochacter)
A *cocharacter* of T^n is

$$\lambda \in \mathrm{Hom}_{\text{alg-gp}}(\mathbb{C}^*, \mathsf{T}^n)$$

We also call them *one-parameter subgroup*.

We can check that

$$N = \mathrm{Hom}_{\text{alg-gp}}(\mathbb{C}^*, \mathsf{T}^n) \cong \mathbb{Z}^n$$

by showing that any $\lambda \in N$ is of the form

$$\lambda(t) = (t^{u_1}, \ldots, t^{u_n})$$

for $\mathbf{u} = (u_1, \ldots, u_n) \in \mathbb{Z}$. So we can write the above cocharacter as $\lambda_{\mathbf{u}}$ as before. N is a group, and the identification is a group isomorphism. That is,

$$\lambda_{\mathbf{u}} \cdot \lambda_{\mathbf{u}'} = \lambda_{\mathbf{u}+\mathbf{u}'}$$

Example 2.4
For $n = 2$, we can identify

$$\mathsf{T}^2 = \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} t_1 & 0 \\ 0 & t_2 \end{pmatrix} \;\middle|\; t_1 t_2 \neq 0 \right\}$$

Under the identification $M \cong N \cong \mathbb{Z}^2$,

$$\chi^{(a,b)} \begin{pmatrix} t_1 & 0 \\ 0 & t_2 \end{pmatrix} = t_1^a \cdot t_2^b$$

and

$$\lambda_{(u,v)}(t) = \begin{pmatrix} t^u & 0 \\ 0 & t^v \end{pmatrix}$$

Definition 2.5 (lattice)
A *lattice* is a free abelian group of finite rank.

Note that with this definition, any lattice is isomorphic to $\mathbb{Z}^n$ when we choose a basis.

Example 2.6
$\mathbb{Z}, 2\mathbb{Z}, \mathbb{Z} \oplus \mathbb{Z}, \mathbb{Z} \oplus 3\mathbb{Z}, \ldots$ are all lattices.

There is a *perfect pairing*[1], given by

$$\begin{aligned}\langle \cdot, \cdot \rangle : M \times N &\to \mathbb{Z} \\ \langle \mathbf{a}, \mathbf{u} \rangle = \mathbf{a} \cdot \mathbf{u} &= a_1 u_1 + \cdots + a_n u_n\end{aligned}$$

In a coordinate-free manner,

$$\begin{aligned}M \times N = \mathrm{Hom}(\mathbb{C}^*, \mathrm{T}^n) \times \mathrm{Hom}(\mathrm{T}^n, \mathbb{C}^*) &\to \mathrm{Hom}(\mathbb{C}^*, \mathbb{C}^*) \\ (\lambda, \chi) &\mapsto \chi \circ \lambda\end{aligned}$$

Using the identification $\mathrm{Hom}(\mathbb{C}^*, \mathbb{C}^*) \cong \mathbb{Z}$ as before gives the pairing.

We can describe a torus T_N starting from a lattice N, through

$$\mathrm{T}_N = N \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} \mathbb{C}^*$$

with this,

$$\mathrm{Hom}(\mathbb{C}^*, \mathrm{T}_N) = N$$

Formally,

$$\mathrm{T}_N = \mathrm{Spec}(\mathbb{Z}[N] \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} \mathbb{C}[x, x^{-1}])$$

With this, give a torus T, we get two dual lattices N, M. Conversely, given a lattice N, we get a torus T_N and a dual lattice M. Choosing a basis on one gives a basis on the other two.

3 Cocharacters and limit points - Part I

Back to toric varieties. Let X be a toric variety, with torus T. We can think of X as a "partial compactification" of T. That is, we can construct X by adding limit points[2] to T.

Given a one-parameter subgroup $\mathbf{u} \in N$, we have

$$\lambda_{\mathbf{u}} : \mathbb{C}^* \to \mathrm{T} \subseteq X$$

We can ask when does

$$\lim_{t \to 0} \lambda_{\mathbf{u}}(t)$$

exist in X. The idea will be that we can determine X by saying which $\lambda_{\mathbf{u}}$ have a limit. See later.

Example 3.1

Consider $\mathrm{T}^2 \subseteq \mathbb{P}^2_{z_0:z_1:z_2}$. The embedding is given by $(t_1, t_2) \mapsto (1 : t_1 : t_2)$. Choose $\mathbf{u} \in \mathbb{Z}^2$, so $\mathbf{u} = (u_1, u_2)$.

$$\lim_{t \to 0} \lambda_{\mathbf{u}}(t) = \lim_{t \to 0} (1 : t^{u_1} : t^{u_2})$$

All these limit points exist, since $\mathbb{P}^2$ is complete[a]. In particular, if $u_1, u_2 > 0$, the limit is $(1 : 0 : 0)$. If $u_1 < 0, u_2 > u_1$, the limit is $(0 : 1 : 0)$. Similarly if $u_2 < 0, u_1 > u_2$ then the limit is $(0 : 0 : 1)$.

The upshot is that we have partitioned $N_{\mathbb{R}} = N \otimes \mathbb{R} = \mathbb{R}^2$ into cones, so that if $\mathbf{u}_1, \mathbf{u}_2$ are in the same cone if and only if they have the same limit. In fact, we can construct $\mathbb{P}^2$ from this.

[a] Or in algebraic geometry, it satisfies the valuative criterion for properness for some choice of DVR.

Lecture 3

4 Affine toric varieties and cones

Definition 4.1 (cone)

A *(rational polyhedral) cone* is

$$\sigma \subseteq N_{\mathbb{R}} = N \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} \mathbb{R} = \mathbb{R}^n$$

[1] That is, it induces isomorphism $\mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(M, \mathbb{Z}) = M^\vee \cong N$ and vice versa.

[2] In the Euclidean topology.

where

$$\sigma = \sum_{i \in I} \lambda_i u_i \mid \lambda_i \geq 0, u_1, \ldots, u_n \in \mathbb{N}$$

We will also write

$$\sigma = \text{Cone}(u_1, \ldots, u_r)$$

and the set $\{u_i\}_{i=1}^r$ is the set of generators of the cone.

Example 4.2

If $N_{\mathbb{R}} \cong \mathbb{R}e$, then we have the cone $\sigma_1 = \text{Cone}(e)$,
Next, $\sigma_2 = \text{Cone}((1,0))$ is
and $\sigma_3 = \text{Cone}((1,0),(0,1))$ is
and $\sigma_4 = \text{Cone}((1,0),(1,2))$ is

Definition 4.3 (dimension)

The *dimension* of a cone σ is $\dim(\sigma) = \dim(V)$, where $V = \text{span}\{\sigma\} \subseteq N_{\mathbb{R}}$. A cone is *top-dimensional* if $V = N_{\mathbb{R}}$.

Definition 4.4 (strongly convex)

σ is *strongly convex* if it does not contain any lines through the origin. Equivalently, $\sigma \cap -\sigma = \{0\}$.

We would like to associate a to a cone σ, an affine toric variety $U_\sigma = \text{Spec}(R_\sigma)$. That is, we would like to define

$$R_d \subseteq \mathbb{C}[x_1^{\pm 1}, \ldots, x_n^{\pm 1}]$$

a sub-$\mathbb{C}$-algebra.

We will do this as follows:

1. We will associate a *dual cone* $\sigma^\vee \subseteq M_{\mathbb{R}}$,
2. Then we will generate a commutative semigroup S_σ,
3. from this, we will define R_σ.

4.1 Dual cone

Definition 4.5 (dual cone)

The *dual cone* $\sigma^\vee$ of σ is

$$\check{\sigma} = \{m \in M_{\mathbb{R}} \mid \langle u, m \rangle \geq 0 \text{ for all } u \in \sigma\} \subseteq M_{\mathbb{R}}$$

where we extend the pairing to $N_{\mathbb{R}} \otimes M_{\mathbb{R}} \to \mathbb{R}$.

Example 4.6

Using the same examples as before, we have the dual cones $\check{\sigma_1}$
and $\check{\sigma_2}$,
Note here we see that the dual cone depends on the embedding (or lattice). Moroever, the dual of a strongly convex cone does not have to be strongly convex.

Fact: $\check{\check{\sigma}} = \sigma$.

Lemma 4.7. The dual $\check{\sigma}$ of a cone σ is a cone.

Proof. We'll define an algorithm to find $m_1, \dots, m_s \in M$, such that

$$\check{\sigma} = \text{Cone}(m_1, \dots, m_s)$$

From linear algebra, for $m \in M = N^\vee$, we have a hypersurface

$$m^\perp = H_m = \{u \in N_\mathbb{R} \mid \langle u, m\rangle = 0\}$$

We also have half spaces

$$H_m^+ = \{u \in N_\mathbb{R} \mid \langle m, u\rangle \geq 0\}$$

Definition 4.8 (supporting hyperplane)
A *supporting hyperplane* of σ is H_m, such that $\sigma \subseteq H_m^+$. Equivalently, $m \in \check{\sigma}$.

Now note that

$$\check{\sigma} = \text{Cone}(m_1, \dots, m_s) \iff \sigma = \bigcap_{i=1}^{s} H_{m_i}^+$$

So to construct $\check{\sigma}$, we need to express σ as an intersection of half spaces.

For example, $\check{\sigma}_3 = \text{Cone}((1,0),(0,1))$

and similarly, $\check{\sigma}_4 = \text{Cone}((2,-1),(0,1))$.

In general, we can do this by identifying the *facets* $\tau \preccurlyeq \sigma$, and taking the corresponding dual element $m_\tau \in M$, and

$$\check{\sigma} = \text{Cone}(m_\tau \mid \tau \preccurlyeq \sigma)$$

when σ is top dimensional.

Definition 4.9
A *face* $\tau \preccurlyeq \sigma$ is the intersection $\sigma \cap H_m$, for a supporting hyperplane H_m. Note that the faces are all cones, and we call τ a *facet* if $\dim(\tau) = \dim(\sigma) - 1$, and τ an *edge* if $\dim(\tau) = 1$.

Note by taking $m = 0$, $\sigma \preccurlyeq \sigma$.

When σ is not top dimensional, then $\text{span}_\mathbb{R}(\sigma) = W \neq N_\mathbb{R}$. Write $\overline{\sigma}$ for σ considered as a subspace of W. Now $\overline{\sigma}$ is top-dimensional, and so we can the dual

$$\check{\overline{\sigma}} \subseteq \frac{M_\mathbb{R}}{W^\perp}$$

Say

$$\check{\overline{\sigma}} = \text{Cone}(\overline{m_1}, \dots, \overline{m_s})$$

where

$$\overline{m_i} \in \frac{M_\mathbb{R}}{W^\perp}$$

Choose representatives $m_i \in M_\mathbb{R}$, and choose a basis $m_{s+1}, \dots, m_k$ of $W^\perp$ in $M_\mathbb{R}$. With this,

$$\check{\sigma} = \text{Cone}(m_1, \dots, m_s, \pm m_{s+1}, \dots, \pm m_k)$$

□

4.2 Commutative semigroup

Definition 4.10 (commutative semigroup)
A *commutative semigroup* is $(S, +)$, such that $+$ is an associative commutative binary operation on S.

In particular, a semigroup with identity is called a *monoid*. S is *finitely generated* if there exists $A \subseteq S$ finite, such that

$$S = \left\{ \sum_n \lambda_n a_n \;\middle|\; \lambda_n \in \mathbb{Z}_{>0}, a_n \in A \right\}$$

S is *affine* if it is finitely generated, and $(S, +)$ is a subsemigroup of a lattice $(\mathbb{Z}^n, +)$.

Example 4.11

Any group is a semigroup. Given a (not necessarily unital) ring R, R under multiplication is a semigroup. For example, $\mathbb{Z}_{>0}$ is a semigroup under multiplication, but this is not finitely generated.

Lecture 4

Definition 4.12

Let σ be a cone. Define

$$S_\sigma = \check{\sigma} \cap M \subseteq M_{\mathbb{R}}$$

for the semigroup associated to σ.

This is a semigroup as cones are closed under addition. Now we want to show that this is affine. This does not follow immediately from being a subgroup of $(\mathbb{Z}^n, +)$. For example, consider

$$S = \{(x, y) \mid x \leq \sqrt{2}y\}$$

This is a semigroup, but it is not finitely generated.

Lemma 4.13 (Gordan's lemma)**.** If σ is a cone, then S_σ is a finitely generated semigroup.

Proof. We know that $\check{\sigma} = \mathrm{Cone}(m_1, \ldots, m_r)$, for some $m_i \in M$. Say $x \in S_\sigma$. By definition,

$$x = \sum_{i=1}^{r} \alpha_i m_i$$

where $\alpha_i \in \mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}$. Write

$$\alpha_i = a_i + b_i$$

where $a_i = \lfloor \alpha_i \rfloor$, $b_i = \{\alpha_i\} \in [0, 1)$. Then

$$x = \sum_i a_i m_i + \sum_i b_i m_i$$

Now $x \in M$, and $\sum_i a_i m_i \in M$, and M is a group, so

$$\sum_i b_i m_i \in M$$

On the other hand, $\sum b_i m_i$ is contained in a compact set

$$K = \left\{ \sum c_i m_i \mid 0 \leq c_i \leq 1 \right\}$$

Since M is discrete, K is compact, $K \cap M$ is finitely many points, say $K \cap M = \{m_{r+1}, \ldots, m_\ell\}$. Then S_σ is generated by

$$m_1, \ldots, m_r, m_{r+1}, \ldots, m_\ell$$

so it is finitely generated. □

Example 4.14

When $\sigma = \text{Cone}(1)$, then $\check{\sigma} = \text{Cone}(1)$, and so S_σ is generated by 1.

Now if $\sigma = \text{Cone}(e_1) \subseteq \mathbb{R}^2$, then $\check{\sigma} = \text{Cone}(e_1, e_2, -e_2)$, and these are the generators of S_σ.

If $\sigma = \text{Cone}(e_1, e_2) \subseteq \mathbb{R}^2$, then $\check{\sigma} = \text{Cone}(e_1, e_2)$, which are the generators of S_σ.

Finally, if $\sigma = \text{Cone}(e_1, e_1 + 2e_2)$, then $\check{\sigma} = \text{Cone}(e_2, 2e_1 - e_2)$. Here, Gordan's lemma shows that S_σ is generated by

$$e_2, 2e_1 - e_2, e_1$$

4.3 Coordinate ring

Definition 4.15

The algebra $\mathbb{C}[S]$ of a semigroup $(S, +)$ is the $\mathbb{C}$-algebra of finite sums

$$\mathbb{C}[S] = \left\{ \sum_i a_i x^{s_i} \mid a_i \in \mathbb{C}, s_i \in S \right\}$$

with $x^s x^{s'} = x^{s+s'}$.

Example 4.16

The semigroup $\mathbb{Z}^n$ is generated by $e_1, \dots, e_n, -e_1, \dots, -e_n$, so

$$\mathbb{C}[\mathbb{Z}^n] = \mathbb{C}[x_1^{\pm 1}, \dots, x_n^{\pm 1}]$$

where $x_i^{\pm 1} = x^{\pm e_i}$.

Lemma 4.17. If $(S, +)$ is a finitely generated semigroup, $\mathbb{C}[S]$ is a finitely generated $\mathbb{C}$-algebra. If $(S, +)$ is affine, then $\mathbb{C}[S]$ is the algebra of an affine variety.

Proof. If S is generated by $A = \{s_1, \dots, s_\ell\}$, then $\{x^{s_1}, \dots, x^{s_\ell}\}$ generates $\mathbb{C}[S]$ as a $\mathbb{C}$-algebra.

Now suppose S is affine. Then $\mathbb{C}[S]$ is finitely generated by the above, and we have that $(S, +) \subseteq (\mathbb{Z}^n, +)$, so we have

$$\mathbb{C}[S] \subseteq \mathbb{C}[\mathbb{Z}^n] = \mathbb{C}[x_1^{\pm 1}, \dots, x_n^{\pm 1}]$$

So $\mathbb{C}[S]$ is a subring of an integral domain, hence it is an integral domain. To conclude, every finitely generated integral domain is the coordinate ring of an affine variety. □

Define $R_\sigma = \mathbb{C}[S_\sigma]$. From this, we know that $U_\sigma = \text{Spec}(R_\sigma)$ is an affine variety.

Example 4.18

For $\sigma = \text{Cone}(1)$, let $x = x^{e_1}$, then $\mathbb{C}[S_\sigma] = \mathbb{C}[x]$, and so $U_\sigma = \mathbb{A}^1$. The inclusion $\mathbb{C}[x] \subseteq \mathbb{C}[x^{\pm 1}]$ defines the torus.

When $\sigma = \text{Cone}(e_1) \subseteq \mathbb{R}^2$, let $x = x^{e_1}, y = x^{e_2}$, then $\mathbb{C}[S_\sigma] = \mathbb{C}[x, y^{\pm 1}]$, and $U_\sigma = \mathbb{A}^1 \times \mathbb{C}^*$. The torus is given by the inclusion

$$\mathbb{C}[x, y^{\pm 1}] \subseteq \mathbb{C}[x^{\pm 1}, y^{\pm 1}]$$

When $\sigma = \text{Cone}(e_1, e_2) \subseteq \mathbb{R}^2$, set $x = x^{e_1}, y = x^{e_2}$, then $U_\sigma = \text{Spec}(\mathbb{C}[x, y]) = \mathbb{A}^2$.

Finally, when $\sigma = \text{Cone}(e_1, e_1 + 2e_2)$. Let $A = e_1, B = 2e_1 - e_2, C = e_2$. Then S_σ is generated by A, B, C. We have a relation $B + A = 2C$. Define $x = x^A, y = x^B, z = x^C$, then

$$\mathbb{C}[S_\sigma] = \frac{\mathbb{C}[x, y, z]}{\langle xy = z^2 \rangle}$$

With this, $U_\sigma = \text{Spec}(\mathbb{C}[S_\sigma]) = \mathbb{V}(xy - z^2) \subseteq \mathbb{A}^3$. In particular, this is a *singular* toric variety. In this

case, the torus is given by

$$\frac{\mathbb{C}[x,y,z]}{\langle xy-z^2\rangle} \subseteq \mathbb{C}[x^{\pm 1}, z^{\pm 1}] = \mathbb{C}[M]$$

To see this, we have an inclusion

$$\frac{\mathbb{C}[x,y,z]}{\langle xy-z^2\rangle} \subseteq \frac{\mathbb{C}[x^{\pm 1}, y, z^{\pm 1}]}{\langle xy-z^2\rangle}$$

Remark 4.19. We know that $S_\sigma \subseteq M$, and so we have an inclusion of algebras $\mathbb{C}[S_\sigma] \subseteq \mathbb{C}[M]$. A fact from commutative algebra is that, the image of the map

$$\mathrm{T}^n = \mathrm{Spec}(\mathbb{C}[M]) \to U_\sigma = \mathrm{Spec}(\mathbb{C}[S_\sigma])$$

is dense, as these are integral domains.

Remark 4.20. T^n may map to some smaller torus $\mathrm{T}^{n'} \subseteq U_\sigma$, with $n' \leq n$. We claim that if σ is strongly convex, then $\mathrm{T}^n \subseteq U_\sigma$ as a dense open subset. See examples sheet 1, questions 1 and 3. For this, note that σ is strongly convex if and only if $\check{\sigma}$ is top dimensional.

From now on, restrict to strongly convex σ.

Lecture 5

What remains is to construct the torus action. Recall $T_N = \mathrm{Spec}(\mathbb{C}[M])$. We will define this by

$$\begin{aligned} a^\sharp : \mathbb{C}[S_\sigma] &\to \mathbb{C}[S_\sigma] \otimes \mathbb{C}[M] \\ \chi^{\mathbf{m}} &\mapsto \chi^{\mathbf{m}} \otimes \chi^{\mathbf{m}} \end{aligned}$$

This extends

$$\begin{aligned} m^\sharp : \mathbb{C}[M] &\to \mathbb{C}[M] \otimes \mathbb{C}[M] \\ \chi^{\mathbf{m}} &\mapsto \chi^{\mathbf{m}} \otimes \chi^{\mathbf{m}} \end{aligned}$$

Remark 4.21. The reason this works is the fact that $S_\sigma \subseteq M$ tells us which functions on U_σ are monomials.

With this all in mind, given a strongly convex cone σ, we have an affine toric variety U_σ, with torus T_N. We will see that

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \{\text{affine toric varieties}\} & \longrightarrow & \{\text{affine semigroups}\} \\ \uparrow & & \uparrow \\ \{\text{affine } \textit{normal} \text{ toric varieties}\} & \longrightarrow & \{\text{strongly convex cones}\} \end{array}$$

5 Opens in U_σ

We will see that $\tau \preccurlyeq \sigma$, correspond to principal opens $U_\tau \subseteq U_\sigma$. Recall that a face is $\tau = \sigma \cap H_m$ for some $m \in \check{\sigma} \cap M = S_\sigma$.

Theorem 5.1. If $\tau = \sigma \cap H_m$, then

$$\mathbb{C}[S_\tau] = \mathbb{C}[S_\sigma]_{\chi^{\mathbf{m}}} = \mathbb{C}[S_\sigma][\chi^{\pm \mathbf{m}}]$$

Proof. First, since $\tau \in H_m$, $\langle u, m\rangle = 0$ for all $u \in \tau$. So m and $-m$ are in $\check{\tau} \cap M = S_\tau$. Also, if $m' \in S_\sigma$, then $\langle m', u\rangle \geq 0$ for all $u \in \tau$. Putting these together,

$$\mathbb{C}[S_\sigma]_{\chi^{\mathbf{m}}} \subseteq \mathbb{C}[S_\tau]$$

For the reverse inclusion, take $m' \in S_\tau \setminus S_\sigma$. We want to show $m' + km \in S_\sigma$ for some $k \in \mathbb{Z}$. For $u \in \sigma \setminus \tau$, $\langle m', u\rangle < 0$. But we also have that $\langle m, u\rangle > 0$, so we can pick k large enough such that $\langle m' + km, u\rangle > 0$. This tells us that $m' + km \in S_\sigma$[3]. □

Example 5.2

Let $\sigma = \mathrm{Cone}(e_1, e_2)$. Let $\star = (0,0)$. This is a face, and $S_\star = \mathbb{C}[x^{\pm 1}, y^{\pm 1}]$. Hence $U_\star = \mathrm{T} \subseteq \mathbb{A}^2$.

Now if τ_1 is the face $y = 0$, then we get

$$\mathbb{C}[S_{\tau_1}] = \mathbb{C}[x, y]_{\chi^{e_2} = y} = \mathbb{C}[x, y^{\pm 1}]$$

So

$$U_{\tau_1} = \mathbb{A}^1 \times \mathbb{C}^*$$

6 Fans and toric varieties

Definition 6.1 (fan)

A *fan* Σ is a finite collection of strongly convex cones $\sigma \subseteq N_\mathbb{R}$, such that

1. for all $\sigma \in \Sigma$, $\tau \preccurlyeq \sigma$, then $\tau \in \Sigma$.
2. for any $\sigma_1, \sigma_2 \in \Sigma$, $\tau = \sigma_1 \cap \sigma_2$ is a face of both.

Notation 6.2. The *support* of Σ is

$$|\Sigma| = \bigcup_{\sigma \in \Sigma} \sigma \subseteq N_\mathbb{R}$$

and we will write

$$\Sigma(r) \subseteq \Sigma$$

for the subset of r-dimensional cones.

Example 6.3

First, let $\sigma = \mathrm{Cone}(e) \subseteq \mathbb{R}$, then $\Sigma_1 = \{\sigma, -\sigma, \star\}$ is a fan.

Next, we have seen the fan Σ for $\mathbb{P}^2$. Here, $\Sigma(0) = \{\star\}$, $\Sigma(1) = \{\mathrm{Cone}(e_1), \mathrm{Cone}(e_2), \mathrm{Cone}(-e_1 - e_2)\}$ and so on.

Next, consider the cone given by $\sigma_0 = \mathrm{Cone}(e_1, e_1 + e_2)$, $\sigma_1 = \mathrm{Cone}(e_1 + e_2, e_2)$ and their faces.

Finally, consider the rays passing through $(0,1), (1,0), (0,-1), (-1,a)$, for soem $a \in \mathbb{Z}_{>0}$.

By the above construction, we can associate to each $\sigma \in \Sigma$ an affine toric variety, and if $\tau \preccurlyeq \sigma$ is a face, then $U_\tau \subseteq U_\sigma$ is an open. Thus, we can glue the U_σs together, using the explicit open embeddings. This gives an (abstract) variety X_Σ.

Remark 6.4. The second condition will imply separatedness.

Example 6.5

For the first example, $U_\sigma = \mathrm{Spec}(\mathbb{C}[x])$, and $U_{-\sigma} = \mathrm{Spec}(\mathbb{C}[x^{-1}])$. Finally, the origin corresponds to $\mathrm{Spec}(\mathbb{C}[x, x^{-1}])$. So we get $\mathbb{A}^1$ and $\mathbb{A}^1$ glued along $\mathbb{C}^*$, which is $\mathbb{P}^1$.

Lecture 6

[3] Since we only need to show positivity on the finitely many generators of the cone.

Example 6.6

For the fan with for $\mathbb{P}^2$ as above, the dual fan is

diagram

Let

$$x = \chi^{(1,0)}$$
$$y = \chi^{(0,1)}$$

In this case,

$$U_{\sigma_0} = \operatorname{Spec}(\mathbb{C}[x, y])$$
$$U_{\sigma_1} = \operatorname{Spec}(\mathbb{C}[x^{-1}, x^{-1}y])$$
$$U_{\sigma_2} = \operatorname{Spec}(\mathbb{C}[y^{-1}, xy^{-1}])$$

We would like to identify X_Σ with $\mathbb{P}^2$, with homogeneous coordinates $[z_0 : z_1 : z_2]$. If

$$x = \frac{z_1}{z_0} \quad \text{and} \quad y = \frac{z_2}{z_0}$$

This identifies U_{σ_0} with the open $\{z_0 \neq 0\}$. Similarly, we can identify the other opens.

Example 6.7

Consider now the fan given by

$$\sigma_1 = \operatorname{Cone}(e_1, e_1 + e_2)$$
$$\sigma_2 = \operatorname{Cone}(e_1 + e_2, e_2)$$

The dual cones are

$$\sigma_1^\vee = \operatorname{Cone}(e_2, e_1 - e_2)$$
$$\sigma_2^\vee = \operatorname{Cone}(e_1, -e_1 + e_2)$$

Note that the dual of a fan is not a fan. In this case,

$$U_{\sigma_1} = \operatorname{Spec}(\mathbb{C}[y, xy^{-1}])$$
$$U_{\sigma_2} = \operatorname{Spec}(\mathbb{C}[x, x^{-1}y])$$

Set $t = xy^{-1}$. Then we have a projection map to $\mathbb{P}^1$. In particular, this is the total space of $\mathcal{O}(-1)$[a], which is

$$\{xz_1 = yz_0\} \subseteq \mathbb{C}^2_{x,y} \times \mathbb{P}^1_{[z_0,z_1]}$$

Setting $t = z_0/z_1$ gives the identification. This is also the blowup of $\mathbb{A}^2$ at 0.

[a] which is the tautological bundle. Using relative spec, we can also write this as

$$\operatorname{Spec}_{\mathbb{P}^1}\left(\operatorname{Sym}^\bullet_{\mathbb{P}^1} \mathcal{O}(1)\right)$$

More generally, taking the spec of the symmetric algebra associates a vector bundle to a locally free sheaf. The vector bundle has a trivialising open affine cover.

Conversely, for a vector bundle, take the sheaf of sections.

Fact: If Σ_1, Σ_2 are fans, then so is $\Sigma_1 \times \Sigma_2$, and $X_{\Sigma_1 \times \Sigma_2} = X_{\Sigma_1} \times X_{\Sigma_2}$.

7 Affine embeddings and toric ideals

Lecture 7

We'll see two alternative ways of describing toric varieties:

1. toric ideals, $V = \mathbb{V}(I_L) \subseteq \mathbb{A}^s$, where I_L is a toric ideal,
2. torus embedding, $V = \overline{\Phi_{\mathscr{A}}(T)}$, where $\Phi_{\mathscr{A}} : T \to \mathbb{A}^s$ given by monomials.

Recall for $\sigma = \text{Cone}((1,0),(1,2))$, we have $\sigma^\vee = \text{Cone}((0,1),(2,-1))$, and

$$S_\sigma = \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}\mathscr{A}$$

where $\mathscr{A} = \{A, B, C\}$, where $A = (0,1)$, $B = (1,0)$, $C = (2,-1)$. We have a map

$$\begin{aligned} \pi : \mathbb{Z}^3_{A,B,C} &\to M \cong \mathbb{Z}^2 \\ A &\mapsto (0,1) \\ B &\mapsto (1,0) \\ C &\mapsto (2,-1) \end{aligned}$$

As a matrix,

$$\begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 & 2 \\ 1 & 0 & -1 \end{pmatrix}$$

Then

$$\ker(\pi) = \mathbb{Z} \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ -2 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}$$

If we restrict to $\mathbb{N}^3_{A,B,C}$ and S_σ, then we have a surjection of semigroups. In particular, $S_\sigma = \mathbb{N}^3_{A,B,C}/\sim$, where $\sim$ is the relation $A + C = 2B$. On algebras,

$$\mathbb{C}[S_\sigma] = \frac{\mathbb{C}[\mathbb{N}_{A,B,C}]}{I_L}$$

Let $x = \chi^A, y = \chi^B, z = \chi^C$. Then $A + C = 2B$ corresponds to $xz = y^2$. Then $I_L = \langle xz - y^2 \rangle$. In particular, this shows that we have an affine embedding $U_\sigma = \mathbb{V}(I_L) \subseteq \mathbb{A}^3$.

On the other hand, χ^A, χ^B, χ^C are maps $T \to \mathbb{C}^*$. We can define a map

$$\begin{aligned} \Phi_{\mathscr{A}} : T &\to \mathbb{A}^3 \\ (s,t) &\mapsto \left(\chi^A(s,t), \chi^B(s,t), \chi^C(s,t)\right) = (t, s, s^2t^{-1}) \end{aligned}$$

In this case,

$$U_\sigma = \overline{\Phi_{\mathscr{A}}(T)}$$

Moreover, $\Phi_{\mathscr{A}}$ with coordinates s, t, acts on U_σ by

$$(s,t)(x,y,z) = (tx, sy, s^2t^{-1}z)$$

More generally, if S is an affine semigroup, generated by $\mathscr{A} = \{m_1, \ldots, m_s\}$, where $m_i \in M$, a lattice. So $S = \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}\mathscr{A}$. We can associate an ideal and a torus embedding as above.

Definition 7.1

A *lattice ideal* is an ideal I_L in $\mathbb{C}[x_1, \ldots, x_s]$, of the form

$$I_L = \left\langle x^\alpha - x^\beta \mid \alpha - \beta \in L \right\rangle$$

for some lattice L. Note here we use the multi-index notation.

I_L is *toric* if it is prime.

Now given S as above, consider the map

$$\pi : \bigoplus_{i=1}^{s} \mathbb{Z} \cdot m_i \to M$$

and $L = \ker(\pi)$ is a sublattice. These relations give an ideal

$$I_L = \left\langle x^{\ell^+} - x^{\ell^-} \;\middle|\; \ell^+ - \ell^- \in L; \ell^+, \ell^- \in \bigoplus \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0} \cdot m_i \right\rangle$$

This is an ideal of

$$\mathbb{C}[x_1, \ldots, x_s] = \mathbb{C}\left[\bigoplus_{i=1}^{s} \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0} \cdot m_i\right]$$

where $x_i = \chi^{m_i}$. We can define a variety $V = \mathbb{V}(I_L) \subseteq \mathbb{A}^s$.

Now for $\Phi_{\mathscr{A}}$, we recall that $M = \mathbb{Z}S$, and $T_N = \operatorname{Spec}(\mathbb{C}[M])$. We can define

$$\begin{aligned} \Phi_{\mathscr{A}} : T_N &\to \mathbb{A}^s \\ \mathbf{t} &\mapsto (\chi^{m_1}(\mathbf{t}), \ldots, \chi^{m_s}(\mathbf{t})) \end{aligned}$$

Theorem 7.2. If V is an affine variety, then the following are equivalent:

(i) V is an affine toric variety,

(ii) $V = \operatorname{Spec}(\mathbb{C}[S])$ for an affine semigroup S,

(iii) $V = \mathbb{V}(I_L)$ for a toric ideal I_L,

(iv) $V = \overline{\Phi_{\mathscr{A}}(T)}$ for some finite collection $\mathscr{A}$ generating an affine semigroup.

Proof. We have seen (ii) implies (iii) and that (iii) implies (iv). To see that (iv) implies (i), note that $\Phi_{\mathscr{A}}$ gives an action of T on $\mathbb{A}^s$, and if $V = \overline{\Phi_{\mathscr{A}}(T)}$, then $\Phi_{\mathscr{A}}(T) \subseteq V$ is a dense open torus, and we just need to check that for $t \in T$, $t \cdot V \subseteq V$. Now $t \cdot V$ contains $\Phi_{\mathscr{A}}(T)$, so it is contained in the closure of $\Phi_{\mathscr{A}}(T)$, which is V.

For (iv) implies (i), we need a lemma from representation theory:

Lemma 7.3. If $A \subseteq \mathbb{C}[M]$ is a subrepresentation of T_N, then A splits into

$$A = \bigoplus_{m \in S} \mathbb{C} \cdot \chi^m$$

for some subset[a] $S \subseteq M$.

[a] Since the multiplicity in $\mathbb{C}[M]$ is one for each eigenspace, each eigenspace appears either zero or one times, so we can consider a *subset* without thinking about multiplicity.

Note that here, multiplication by t defines a map $T_N \to T_N$, which in turn is a map on coordinate rings $\mathbb{C}[M] \to \mathbb{C}[M]$.

Applying the lemma to $\mathbb{C}[V] \to \mathbb{C}[M]$. The collection S of monomial appearing in $\mathbb{C}[V]$ needs to form a semigroup S, as $\mathbb{C}[V]$ is a ring. This is finitely generated as $\mathbb{C}[V]$ is finitely generated, as it is the coordinate ring of an affine variety. □

Under the correspondence

$$\{\text{affine toric variety}\} \leftrightarrow \{\text{affine semigroups}\}$$

Restricting, we get

$$\{\text{normal affine toric varieties}\} \leftrightarrow \{\text{saturated semigroups}\}$$

Example 7.4

Let $M = \mathbb{Z}$, and $S = \langle 2, 3 \rangle = \{0, 2, 3, \ldots\}$. But we can still construct a toric variety

$$V = \operatorname{Spec}(\mathbb{C}[S])$$

So we have a map

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{Z}^2 &\to \mathbb{Z}\\ e_1 &\mapsto 2\\ e_2 &\mapsto 3\end{aligned}$$

and the kernel is generated by $2e_2 - 3e_1$. Now take $x = \chi^{e_1}, y = \chi^{e_2} \in \mathbb{C}[\mathbb{Z}^2]$. We have an associated ideal, $I_L = \langle y^2 = x^3 \rangle$. Then $C = \operatorname{Spec}(\mathbb{C}[x,y]/I_L) = \mathbb{V}(I_L)$ is the affine toric variety associated to S. In particular, this is a cuspidal cubic.

For a parametrisation, we have

$$\begin{aligned}\Phi_{\mathscr{A}} : \mathbb{C}^* &\to \mathbb{A}^2\\ t &\mapsto (t^2, t^3)\end{aligned}$$

and $C = \overline{\Phi_{\mathscr{A}}(\mathbb{C}^*)}$.

On the other hand, this is not a normal variety.

Lecture 8

Definition 7.5 (normal)

An integral domain R with $K = \operatorname{Frac}(R)$ is *normal* (i.e. integrally closed) if for all $x \in K$, with x being a root of a monic polynomial with coefficients in R, $x \in R$.

Equivalently, if $x^n + a_{n-1}x^{n-1} + \cdots + a_0$, with $a_i \in R$, then $x \in R$.

For an affine variety, it is normal if and only if its coordinate ring is normal. In general, we need to consider stalks, or an affine cover.

Example 7.6

We'll show that $R = \mathbb{C}[x,y]/\langle y^2 - x^3 \rangle$ is not normal. Note that

$$x = \frac{y^2}{x^2} = \left(\frac{y}{x}\right)^2 \in \operatorname{Frac}(R)$$

Now

$$z = \frac{y}{x} \notin R$$

but $z^2 - x^2 = 0$.

Definition 7.7 (saturated)

An affine semigroup $S \subseteq M$ is *saturated* if for every $m \in M, k \in \mathbb{N}$ with $km \in S$, then $m \in S$.

Lemma 7.8. The semigroup S_σ of a (strongly convex) cone is saturated.

Proof. We defined S_σ as the intersection of a cone (which is convex) and M. □

Theorem 7.9. If V is an affine toric variety, with torus T_N, then the following are equivalent:

(i) V is normal,

(ii) $V = \operatorname{Spec}(\mathbb{C}[S_\sigma])$, for some cone σ,

(iii) $V = \mathrm{Spec}(\mathbb{C}[S])$, for some saturated affine semigroup S,

Proof. For (i) implies (iii), if V is affine toric, then $V = \mathrm{Spec}(\mathbb{C}[S])$, for some affine semigroup S. Say $m \in M$, and $km \in S$, for some $k \in \mathbb{Z}_{>0}$. This means that $\chi^{km} \in \mathbb{C}[S]$, and $\chi^m \in \mathbb{C}(S) = \mathrm{Frac}(\mathbb{C}[S])$. But χ^m is the root of the monic integral polynomial

$$y^k - \chi^{km} = 0$$

so $\chi^m \in \mathbb{C}[S]$ as $\mathbb{C}[S]$ is normal.

For (iii) implies (ii), let S be saturated and affine, and let $\mathscr{A}$ be a finite generating set. Define $\sigma^\vee = \mathrm{Cone}(\mathscr{A})$. Then $S = M \cap \sigma^\vee$. Taking the dual gives σ.

For (ii) implies (i), take $\sigma = \mathrm{Cone}(v_1, \ldots, v_r)$. Let ρ_i be the ray generated by v_i. Without loss of generality, we can assume that v_i is a minimal generator of ρ_i. Now we have that

$$\sigma^\vee = \bigcap_{i=1}^{r} H^+_{v_i} = \bigcap_{i=1}^{r} \rho_i^\vee$$

Intersecting with the lattice,

$$S_\sigma = \bigcap_{i=1}^{r} S_{\rho_i}$$

and so

$$\mathbb{C}[S_\sigma] = \bigcap_{i=1}^{r} \mathbb{C}[\rho_i]$$

We just have to check the varieties $U_i = \mathrm{Spec}(\mathbb{C}[S_{\rho_i}])$ are normal. But if we only have one ray ρ, say generated by x_1, then

$$\mathbb{C}[S_\rho] = \mathbb{C}[x_1, x_2^{\pm 1}, \ldots, x_n^{\pm 1}]$$

So $U_\rho = \mathbb{A}^1 \times (\mathbb{C}^*)^{n-1}$ which is normal. □

With this, we have a correspondence

$$\{\text{normal affine toric varieties}\} \leftrightarrow \{\text{strongly convex cones}\}$$

8 Points of U_σ and limit points - Part II

We want $u \in \sigma$ to correspond to one-parameter subgroups $\lambda_u : \mathbb{C}^* \to T \subseteq U_\sigma$, such that

$$\lim_{t \to 0} \lambda_u(t)$$

exists in U_σ (with the Euclidean topology). Equivalently, λ_u extends to a map $\mathbb{C} \to U_\sigma$.

Theorem 8.1. Let σ be a strongly convex cone. Let $u \in N$. Then $u \in \sigma$ if and only if

$$\lim_{t \to 0} \lambda_u(t)$$

exists in U_σ.

Proof. For any $u \in N$, $m \in S_\sigma$, say $\langle u, m \rangle = d \in \mathbb{Z}$. This means that the composition

$$\mathbb{C}^* \xrightarrow{\lambda_u} T \xrightarrow{\chi^m} \mathbb{C}^*$$

is $x \mapsto x^d$. Moreover,

$$u \in \sigma \iff \langle u, m \rangle \geq 0 \text{ for all } m \in S_\sigma \iff \lim_{t \to 0} (\chi^m \circ \lambda_u)(t) \text{ exists for all } m \in S_\sigma$$

So we need to show that

$$\lim_{t \to 0} (\chi^m \circ \lambda_u)(t) \text{ exists for all } m \in S_\sigma \iff \lim_{t \to 0} \lambda_u(t) \text{ exists in } U_\sigma$$

$\Longleftarrow$ is clear. Conversely, recall (a closed point) $x \in U_\sigma$ is a $\mathbb{C}$-algebra homomorphism

$$x^\sharp : \mathbb{C}[S_\sigma] \to \mathbb{C}$$

Define

$$x_0(\chi^m) = \lim_{t\to 0} \chi^m(\lambda_u(t)) = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } \langle u, m\rangle > 0 \\ 1 & \text{if } \langle u, m\rangle = 0 \end{cases}$$

Then

$$\lim_{t\to 0} \lambda_u(t) = x_0$$

□

Remark 8.2.

$$\lim_{t\to 0} \chi^m(\lambda_u(t)) = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } \langle u, m\rangle > 0 \\ 1 & \text{if } \langle u, m\rangle = 0 \end{cases}$$

and the limit does not exist if $\langle u, m\rangle < 0$.

Definition 8.3 (distinguished point)
The *distinguished point of* σ is

$$\begin{aligned} x_\sigma : \mathbb{C}[S_\sigma] &\to \mathbb{C} \\ \chi^m &\mapsto \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } m \in S_\sigma \setminus \sigma^\perp \\ 1 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases} \end{aligned}$$

Note $m \in S_\sigma \setminus \sigma^\perp$ if and only if $\langle u, m\rangle > 0$ for all m.

Lecture 9

Lemma 8.4. We have a one-to-one correspondence between points $x \in U_\sigma$ and semigroup homomorphisms

$$\gamma_x : (S_\sigma, +) \to (\mathbb{C}, \cdot)$$

Proof. For $x \in U_\sigma$, we have a corresponding map

$$\begin{aligned} x^\sharp : \mathbb{C}[S_\sigma] &\to \mathbb{C} \\ x^\sharp(\chi^m) &= \chi^m(x) \end{aligned}$$

and we can take $\gamma_x(m) = \chi^m(x)$. Conversely, given $\gamma : S_\sigma \to \mathbb{C}$, define

$$\begin{aligned} x_\gamma^\sharp : \mathbb{C}[S_\sigma] &\to \mathbb{C} \\ x_\gamma^\sharp(\chi^m) &= \gamma(m) \end{aligned}$$

□

Example 8.5
The distinguished point $x_\sigma \in U_\sigma$ corresponds to the semigroup homomorphism

$$\begin{aligned} \gamma_\sigma : S_\sigma &\to \mathbb{C} \\ \gamma_\sigma(m) &= \begin{cases} 1 & m \in \sigma^\perp \cap S_\sigma \\ 0 & m \in S_\sigma \setminus \sigma^\perp \end{cases} \end{aligned}$$

Corollary 8.6. For all $u \in \mathrm{Int}(\sigma) \cap N$,

$$\lim_{t \to 0} \lambda_u(t) = x_\sigma$$

Example 8.7

Consider the cone $\sigma = \mathrm{Cone}(e_1, e_2) \subseteq \mathbb{R}^2$. In this case, $\sigma^\perp = \{0\}$. Now $U_\sigma = \mathbb{A}^2$, and we would like to find x_σ, x_{τ_1}, where $\tau_1 = \mathrm{Cone}(e_1)$.

First of all, in this case, we have that $\gamma_\sigma(0) = 1$, and $\gamma_\sigma(m) = 0$ otherwise. The corresponding point x_σ is given by

$$\begin{aligned} x_\sigma : \mathbb{C}[S_\sigma] &\to \mathbb{C} \\ \chi^m &\mapsto \begin{cases} 1 & m = 0 \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases} \end{aligned}$$

This is just evaluation at zero of the polynomial ring. So $x_\sigma = (0,0) \in \mathbb{A}^2$. Next, we want to show that this is the limit point for all one-parameter subgroups λ_u, for $u \in \mathrm{Int}(\sigma) \cap N$. That is, $u = (a, b)$, with $a, b > 0$. Now

$$\lambda_{(a,b)}(t) = (t^a, t^b)$$

Since $a, b > 0$,

$$\lim_{t \to 0} \lambda_{(a,b)}(t) = (0,0) = x_\sigma$$

For τ_1, we have that $\tau_1^\vee = \mathrm{Cone}(e_1, e_2, e_2^{-1})$. In this case,

$$U_{\tau_1} = \mathbb{A}^1 \times \mathbb{C}^*$$

and $S_{\tau_1} = \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0} e_1 \oplus \mathbb{Z} e_2$. First of all, $(a, b) \in \mathrm{Int}(\tau_1) \cap N$ if and only if $a > 0, b = 0$. So we have

$$\lambda_{(a,0)}(t) = (t^a, 1)$$

and so

$$\lim_{t \to 0} \lambda_{(a,0)}(t) = (0, 1)$$

On the other hand,

$$\begin{aligned} \gamma_{\tau_1} : S_{\tau_1} &\to \mathbb{C} \\ e_1 &\mapsto 0 \\ e_2 &\mapsto 1 \end{aligned}$$

and so the map is

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{C}[x, y^{\pm 1}] &\to \mathbb{C} \\ x &\mapsto 0 \\ y &\mapsto 1 \end{aligned}$$

and so $x_{\tau_1} = (0, 1)$.

Example 8.8

For $\sigma = \mathrm{Cone}(\varnothing) = \{0\} \subseteq N_\mathbb{R}$. Then $\sigma^\vee = M_\mathbb{R}$, and $S_\sigma = \mathbb{Z} e_1 \oplus \cdots \oplus \mathbb{Z} e_n$. Then

$$\mathbb{C}[S_\sigma] = \mathbb{C}[x_1^{\pm 1}, \ldots, x_n^{\pm 1}]$$

The distinguished point is given by $\gamma_\sigma(m) = 1$ for all m. So we have the point $(1, \ldots, 1)$, which is the identity of the group $T_N = U_\sigma$. This is the limit point for all $u \in \mathrm{Int}(\sigma)$.

9 Smoothness

Lemma 9.1. If $\sigma = \mathrm{Cone}(v_1, \dots, v_k)$ for $v_i \in N$, and suppose $v_1, \dots, v_k$ can be completed to a $\mathbb{Z}$-basis $v_1, \dots, v_n$ of N. Then $U_\sigma \cong \mathbb{A}^k \times (\mathbb{C}^*)^{n-k}$.

Moreover, we claim that these are the only non-singular affine toric varieties.

Proof. Complete $v_1, \dots, v_k$ to a basis $v_1, \dots, v_n$. Then S_σ is generated by $w_1^*, \dots, w_k^*, \pm w_{k+1}^*, \dots, \pm w_n^*$. So

$$\mathbb{C}[S_\sigma] = \mathbb{C}[x_1, \dots, x_k] \otimes \mathbb{C}[x_{k+1}^{\pm 1}, \dots, x_n^{\pm 1}]$$

□

Recall if $v_1, \dots, v_n \in \mathbb{Z}^n$ forms a basis of $\mathbb{R}^n$, it does not have to form a basis of $\mathbb{Z}^n$.

Example 9.2

Take $v_1 = (1, 0), v_2 = (1, 2)$. These form a $\mathbb{R}$-basis, but not a $\mathbb{Z}$-basis. In this case, U_σ is a singular variety.

In general, if $v_1, \dots, v_n \in \mathbb{Z}^n$ are $\mathbb{R}$-linearly independent, then they form a basis of $\mathbb{Z}^n$ if and only if

$$V = \begin{pmatrix} \vdots & & \vdots \\ v_1 & \cdots & v_n \\ \vdots & & \vdots \end{pmatrix} \in \mathrm{GL}(n, \mathbb{Z})$$

Equivalently, $\det(V) = \pm 1$.

Definition 9.3 (regular point)

Let X be a variety of dimension n. Then $x \in X$ is called a *regular* or *nonsingular* point if $\dim_{\mathbb{C}}(\Omega_{X,x}) = n$. Otherwise, we say that x is a singular point.

Here, $\Omega_{X,x}$ is the Zariski cotangent space to x at X. Recall that a closed point $x \in \mathrm{Spec}(R)$ corresponds to $x^\sharp : R \to \mathbb{C}$, and defines a maximal ideal $\mathfrak{m}_x = \ker(x^\sharp)$.

Then

$$\Omega_{X,x} = \frac{\mathfrak{m}_x}{\mathfrak{m}_x^2}$$

This is a $\mathbb{C}$-vector space.

Definition 9.4

We say that X is *smooth* or *nonsingular*, if X has no singular points.

Note that over some fields, smooth implies non-singular, but the converse is false. An alternative definition of smoothness:

Proposition 9.5 (Jacobian criterion). Let $V = \mathbb{V}(f_1, \dots, f_r) \subseteq \mathbb{A}^s$ be an affine variety of dimension d. Then V is *smooth* at $x \in V$ if and only if the matrix

$$J_{(f_1,\dots,f_r)}(x) = \left(\frac{\partial f_i}{\partial x_j} \right)_{i=1,\dots,r; j=1,\dots,s}$$

has rank $s - d$ for all $x \in V$.

We can identify $\ker(J(x)) = (\mathfrak{m}_x/\mathfrak{m}_x^2)^\vee$. In terms of differential geometry, we have a map $F : \mathbb{A}^s \to \mathbb{A}^r$, and $\ker(\mathrm{d}F) = TV$.

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